Blood Pressure: Educational Reference Notes

Blood pressure is the force of circulating blood against artery walls. A reading is written as systolic pressure over diastolic pressure. Persistently high blood pressure is called hypertension and can increase the risk of heart and blood-vessel disease. A single reading does not establish a diagnosis; measurement and interpretation should be discussed with a qualified health professional. Healthy habits that can support blood-pressure management include eating a balanced diet, limiting excess salt, being physically active, avoiding tobacco, and following professional advice. Home monitoring can help track readings over time when a clinician recommends it. Use a correctly sized cuff, sit quietly, support the arm, and follow the device instructions. People should not change prescribed medicines based only on an isolated home reading.